DEPARTMENT OF STATE

THE UNDER SECRETARY

357

November 30, 1943

to
Letter
President

The Secretary:

SUBJECT: Ambassador Gauss' despatch #1693 on China's War Effort

I have reviewed Mr. Ballantine's attached memorandum of November 25 and agree that it might be well to pass along the conclusion from Ambassador Gauss' despatch to the President. I have had a memorandum prepared which you may wish to consider sending.

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U:ERS:HR:DMK

memo sent to President on Dec. 2

FW 740.0011 PACIFIC WAR/3529

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256 DEPARTMENT OF STATE

DIVISION OF FAR EASTERN AFFAIRS

November 25, 1943

December 2, 1943

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Mr. Stettinius:
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Mr. Secretary:

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Ambassador Gauss reports in his despatch no. 1693, October 18, 1943, his conversation on October 4 with Generalissimo Chiang Kai-shek during which he found an opportunity to emphasize the determination with which the American Government and the people are devoting themselves to winning the war and the thought that the United States looked to its allies, including China, to put forth all effort to this end. At the conclusion of the Ambassador's effective presentation of these two thoughts Generalissimo Chiang said that China could be counted upon to do her full share. He added that when the Burma Road is opened China can receive necessary arms and equipment to do more.

In commenting upon his recent interviews with the Generalissimo and other Chinese leaders, Ambassador Gauss said that he had found the leaders almost universally and sincerely friendly to the United States; that they looked upon the United States as China's best friend; and that they are anxious that China maintain the good opinion as well as the goodwill of the United States. In recent reports the Ambassador has stressed the close attention which is given in Chungking to American opinion and comment regarding the China situation, and in the present report evidence is given that in several

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recent decisions taken by the Chinese Government on political matters, the possible American reaction thereto had been carefully studied before decision was made.

The Ambassador's summation of his impressions is quoted in full:

> "In conclusion, I would say that while we have perhaps succeeded in impressing upon some officials the need for increased and more effective war effort on the part of China and while also there may be resulting some minor improvement in some aspects of the situation, we cannot safely count under present conditions (which involve of course the question of equipment for the Chinese forces) on effecting any significant psychological change in the Chinese attitude which will impel China's leaders and soldiers to put forth materially greater effort in the war against Japan. The Chinese have persuaded themselves that the war in Europe will shortly end and that the United States, possibly with help from Great Britain, will defeat Japan; that the Chinese are too tired and too worn and too ill-equipped to make greater effort, especially when such effort may not be necessary; and that the Chinese can sit back, holding what they have against the Japanese, and concentrate their planning upon China's post-war political and economic problems."

It is suggested that you may wish to bring the above summary of Ambassador Gauss' views on this

important

important subject to the attention of the President.

FE:Perkins:MHP